

N8N CHEAT SHEET

KEYBOARD SHORTCUTS

Workflow

Create workflow	( Ctrl Alt  Cmd + Option) + N
Open workflow	( Ctrl  Cmd) + O
Save workflow	( Ctrl  Cmd) + S
Undo	( Ctrl  Cmd) + Z
Redo	( Ctrl  Cmd) + Shift + Z
Execute workflow	( Ctrl  Cmd) + Enter

Canvas

Navigate on the canvas	( Ctrl  Cmd) + left mouse button + drag ( Ctrl  Cmd) + middle mouse button + drag Space + drag Middle mouse button + drag Touchscreen / trackpad: two-finger swipe
Zoom out	-
Zoom in	+
Zoom out / in	( Ctrl  Cmd) + mouse wheel Touchscreen / trackpad: pinch zoom
Reset zoom	0
Zoom to fit workflow	1

Nodes on the canvas

Open node details	Double click on node
Open sub-workflow in new tab	( Ctrl  Cmd) + double click sub-workflow node
Select all nodes	( Ctrl  Cmd) + A
Paste node	( Ctrl  Cmd) + V
Add sticky note	Shift + S

When node(s) selected in canvas

Select previous node	←
Select all previous nodes	Shift + ←
Select subsequent node	→
Select all subsequent nodes	Shift + →
Select subsequent sibling node	↓
Select previous sibling node	↑
Copy node	( Ctrl  Cmd) + C
Cut node	( Ctrl  Cmd) + X
Deactivate node	D
Delete node	Backspace
Open node	Enter
Rename node	( F2  Fn + F2)
Pin data in node	P
Open sub-workflow in new tab	( Ctrl  Cmd) + Shift + O

Node panel

Open node panel	Tab
Insert selected node into workflow	Enter
Close node panel	Escape

Node panel categories

Open / close category	Enter
Open category	→
Close category	←

Within nodes

Empty parameter: switch to expression	=
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DATA

Data types

String	Text value in "", e.g. "Hello"
Number	Numeric value, e.g. 35
Date & Time	Timestamp in ISO 8601 format, e.g. "2025-08-03T09:45:00.000Z"
Boolean	Boolean value: true or false
Array	Ordered list of values in [], e.g. [1, 2, 3]
Object	Data container with key-value pairs in {}, e.g. { "name": "Anna", "age": 30 }

Data structure in n8n

Data in n8n is passed from one node to another as an array of objects.



Load & pin execution data

Pin output data of a single node

1. Execute workflow / node / previous nodes
2. Open node details
3. Output view: click pin 

Load execution data & pin data of first node

1. Execute workflow
2. Open execution
3.  Copy to editor (execution successful) /  Cancel in editor (execution failed)

Edit pinned data / mock data

1. Open node details
2. Output view: click pencil 

EXPRESSIONS

= Placeholders used to dynamically set node parameters based on data from previous executions, other nodes, or the n8n environment

Commonly used expressions:

Date & Time

{{ \$now }}	Current timestamp
{{ \$now.format("dd.MM.yyyy") }}	Formatted current timestamp
{{ \$today }}	Current timestamp rounded down to the day

Incoming data from a node

{{ \$json }}	Incoming JSON data
{{ \$binary }}	Incoming binary data (e.g. images, PDFs)

Output of other nodes

{{ \$("\$<node-name>").item }}	e.g. {{ \$(Trigger).item.json.id }}
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n8n metadata

{{ \$env }}	Environment variables from the n8n configuration
{{ \$vars }}	Global variables set in n8n

NODES

= Building blocks of a workflow that perform various tasks, e.g. starting a workflow, retrieving & sending data, processing data

Commonly used nodes:

Workflow trigger	
Trigger manually	Trigger manually
Schedule trigger	At a specific time interval, e.g. daily at 8 AM
On app event	On a specific event in an app, e.g. Gmail
Webhook	On incoming HTTP request
Exec. by another workflow	When called from another workflow
Form submission	On n8n form submission
Chat message	On incoming chat message
Data manipulation	
Edit fields	Modify/add/remove item fields
Filter	Filter items based on specific criteria
Remove duplicates	Remove duplicate items
Split out	Split a list in an item field into separate items
Aggregate	Aggregate fields/items into a single item
Merge	Merge data from multiple data streams
Sort	Sort items
Convert to file	Convert JSON data into a file (e.g. CSV)
Extract from file	Convert a file (e.g. CSV) into JSON

Flow

If	Branches workflow into true / false paths
Switch	Branches workflow into multiple paths
Loop	Repeats nodes for batches of items
Wait	Pauses workflow (e.g. for a specific time)

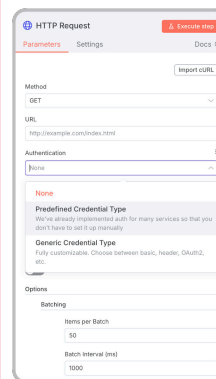
AI

AI Agent	Uses AI models to perform tasks
OpenAI, Gemini, Anthropic	Interacts with the respective AI model
Information Extractor	Extracts data from text

Core

Code	Executes JavaScript or Python code
HTTP-Request	Performs HTTP request and returns response
Execute Sub-workflow	Executes a sub-workflow

HTTP REQUEST NODE

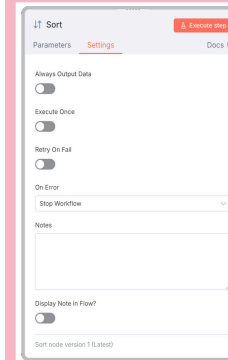


- **Import cURL**
Automatically import HTTP request
• Copy cURL from API docs
• Paste via "Import cURL"

- **Authentication**
• Use Authentication field + credentials instead of name/value pairs in the header parameters
• Disadvantages of manual header parameters:
• Sensitive data visible
• Not reusable

- **Batching Option**
Bypass rate limiting when sending many requests

NODE SETTINGS



Output / Execution

Always Output Data	Outputs single empty item if output would otherwise be empty to prevent workflow from stopping
Execute Once	Executes node only once with first input item
Retry on fail	Re-executes in case of an error

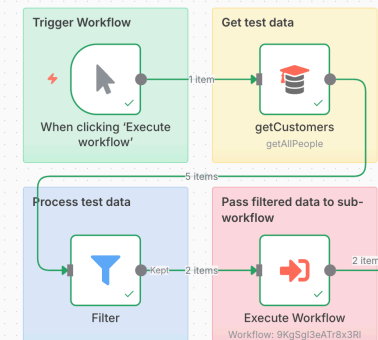
Error

Stop Workflow	Stops current workflow execution
Continue	Error message is output as item in the regular output
Continue (using error output)	Error message is output as item in a separate output

Notes

Notes	Custom note on the node
Display Note in Flow?	Shows the note below the node in the workflow when enabled

EXAMPLE WORKFLOW



PHILIP THOMAS

YOUTUBE: [@PHILIPTHOMAS_DE](https://www.youtube.com/@philipthomas_de)

WEBSITE: [PHILIPTHOMAS.DE/EN](https://philipthomas.de/en)

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